NORTHLINE SYSTEMS
Employee Handbook
Effective date: 1 March 2026
Document owner: People Operations
Classification: Internal

1. Purpose
This handbook describes employment expectations at Northline Systems, a fictional company created for software demonstration. It does not describe any real employer.

2. Working hours
Standard office hours are 09:00 to 18:00, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour unpaid lunch break. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 in the employee's primary time zone. Teams may agree a flexible start between 08:00 and 10:00 if coverage is maintained.

3. Probation
New employees complete a 90-day probation period. During probation, either party may end employment with seven calendar days' written notice. A probation review meeting is held between day 70 and day 85.

4. Compensation and pay cycle
Salaries are paid monthly on the last working day of each month. Overtime for eligible non-exempt roles requires written pre-approval from the line manager. Unapproved overtime is not compensated.

5. Annual leave
Full-time employees are entitled to 18 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accrued monthly. Unused annual leave may be carried over to a maximum of 5 days, which must be used by 31 March of the following year.

6. Public holidays
Northline observes 10 public holidays each year. The holiday calendar is published by People Operations in December for the following year.

7. Conduct
Employees must treat colleagues, contractors, and customers with respect. Harassment, discrimination, and retaliation are prohibited. Suspected misconduct should be reported to People Operations or through the confidential ethics mailbox ethics@northline.example.

8. Equipment
Northline provides a laptop, account credentials, and required software. Company equipment remains Northline property and must be returned on the last working day. Personal software may not be installed on company laptops without IT approval.

9. Performance
Formal performance reviews occur twice each year, in June and December. Goals are documented in the People Portal. A rating of "Needs improvement" triggers a 60-day development plan.

10. Leaving Northline

Resigning employees should give 30 calendar days' written notice after probation. Exit interviews are optional. Access to systems is revoked at end of the last working day unless People Operations approves a shorter period for cause.